

# Hearth OS

Progress report · version 0.23.0 · 30 September 2026

Hearth OS turns a living-room PC into a TV-style home screen for Steam, emulation, streaming apps and Quick Resume, driven by a controller, a TV remote or a Wii Remote. It's built on Bazzite and installs as a system image that updates itself and can always be rolled back. It runs on AMD and Intel graphics; NVIDIA is left for later.

**16,004**

lines of code

**399**

automated tests

**26**

versions released

**26**

pull requests merged

**14**

guides in docs/

Since 0.22.4: code +519, tests +18. Tested on: Ryzen 7 5800X3D, Radeon RX 6750 XT, 24 GB, 256 GB SATA SSD, Xbox controller, Wii Remotes on a DolphinBar.

## What's new in 0.23.0

- **Pictures on the tiles:** Settings is a gearbox, Sleep a moon, Restart a lap of a circuit, Power Off an engine start button, and so on. Apps from Flathub show their own icon.
- **Erasing a drive asks for your password** (Settings → Storage), the one Desktop Mode and *sudo* use. Using a drive as it is doesn't.
- **Game art finds itself:** emulated games without a picture get one from libretro's free thumbnail library, in the background. *hearthctl art* fetches them now; off in Settings → Home screen.
- **GitHub's *gh* command and *tmux* are built in**, so Claude Code on the PC can file field reports, and keeps working if the SSH connection drops (*tmux new -A -s claude*).

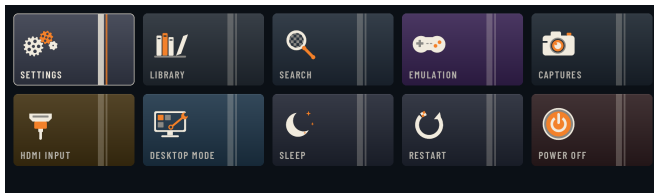
## What's working

| Area               | What it does                                                                                                                              | Status                                |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Home screen        | TV-style rows, liveries, a drawing or icon on every tile, a backdrop from the focused game, controller batteries and network by the clock | Confirmed on the PC                   |
| Emulation          | ES-DE with a tile per console; emulators tuned for the GPU and TV; game art found automatically                                           | Confirmed on the PC (Dolphin working) |
| Wii Remote         | DolphinBar pointer on the home screen and as a mouse; handed to Dolphin for Wii games                                                     | Confirmed on the PC (pointer working) |
| Quick Resume       | Hold Guide to pause a game and pick it up later (up to 3)                                                                                 | Shipped                               |
| Quick Menu         | Guide button panel: audio, per-app volume, Discord, stats, power, updates, screenshots                                                    | Shipped                               |
| Streaming          | YouTube (VacuumTube), Twitch (VacuumStream), Kodi, Jellyfin, Plex, Moonlight                                                              | Shipped                               |
| Game stores        | Epic Games (Heroic), Battle.net, EA app and Ubisoft Connect (Lutris) tiles; their games in the Library                                    | Shipped                               |
| Customising        | Favorites with X, move tiles, hide tiles, liveries, sounds                                                                                | Shipped                               |
| Search and details | Search every app and game; Y on a game for play time and last played                                                                      | Shipped                               |
| Settings           | Wi-Fi, static IP and DNS, Bluetooth, audio devices, storage (format and use a new drive)                                                  | Shipped                               |
| Captures           | Screenshots from the Quick Menu, a gallery tile, in the screen saver                                                                      | Shipped                               |

| Area                | What it does                                                                       | Status                                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Watch next          | Shows and films in progress from Jellyfin, Plex and Kodi; resumes and reports back | Shipped                                        |
| Family              | Daily game-time limit, bedtime and locked tiles behind a PIN                       | Shipped                                        |
| Privacy             | No ads or tracking; a guide to turn off the TV's own tracking, by make             | Shipped                                        |
| TV control (CEC)    | TV on and to the right input on wake and on Guide; standby with the PC             | Shipped                                        |
| Performance         | Hearth idles under 2% of one core and about 300 MB; hearthctl footprint            | Shipped                                        |
| Updates             | Automatic, versioned, with releases on GitHub, a what's-new card and rollback      | Shipped                                        |
| Phone as a remote   | A web page with a d-pad and keyboard, paired with a code on the TV                 | Not started                                    |
| Profiles, folders   | Per-person favorites; groups of tiles                                              | Not started<br>(deferred for now)              |
| NVIDIA graphics     | A separate image with NVIDIA's driver                                              | Not started<br>(deferred: AMD and Intel first) |
| Netflix and similar | DRM limits these to low quality on any home-built PC                               | Not possible                                   |

Confirmed means reported working on the real PC; Shipped means built, tested and released, but not yet reported on.

## Screenshots

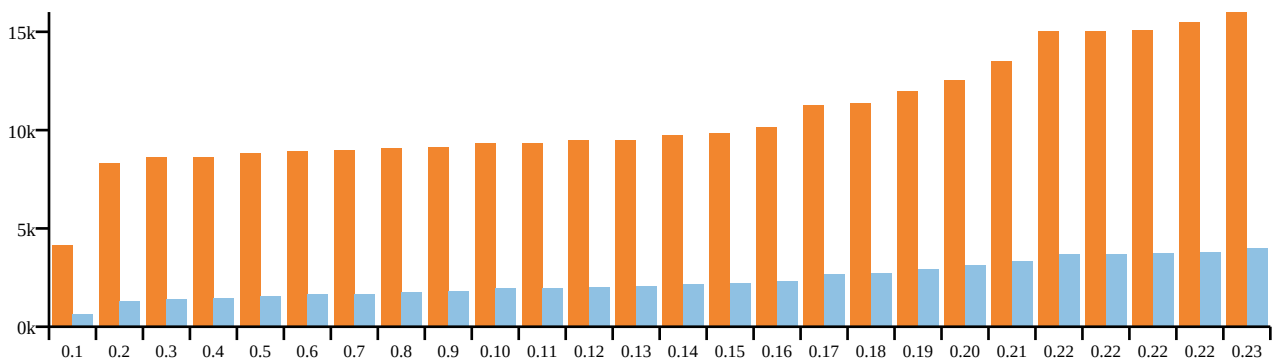


The System tiles, each with its own drawing.

## Lines of code by part

| Part                                          | Lines  |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------|
| Home screen, Quick Menu and settings (Python) | 13,455 |
| System image (scripts, services, config)      | 1,167  |
| Build and tools                               | 1,382  |
| Tests                                         | 5,530  |

## Growth



Lines of code (orange) and automated tests (blue, ×10) at each version.

## Open issues

| Issue                                    | Where it stands                                                   | What's needed                                              |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Steam "Switch to Desktop" can still hang | Holding Guide for 4 s always gets you home; the cause isn't known | hearthctl status and hearthctl logs right after it happens |
| Recent updates not yet tried on the PC   | Built and tested in a virtual display                             | Update, then try the checklist in the release notes        |

## Next

- Your phone as a remote, with a keyboard for search and Wi-Fi passwords.
- Fix what turns up on the real PC.
- When wanted: profiles and groups of tiles; NVIDIA support.

## Every version

| Version | Date       | Lines of code | Tests | Docs (lines) | Pull requests |
|---------|------------|---------------|-------|--------------|---------------|
| 0.23.0  | 2026-09-30 | 16,004        | 399   | 1,821        | 26            |
| 0.22.4  | 2026-09-30 | 15,485        | 381   | 1,773        | 26            |
| 0.22.2  | 2026-09-30 | 15,066        | 374   | 1,556        | 26            |
| 0.22.1  | 2026-09-30 | 15,008        | 370   | 1,548        | 25            |
| 0.22.0  | 2026-09-29 | 15,005        | 369   | 1,544        | 24            |
| 0.21.0  | 2026-09-29 | 13,506        | 334   | 1,371        | 23            |
| 0.20.0  | 2026-09-29 | 12,533        | 312   | 1,260        | 20            |
| 0.19.0  | 2026-09-29 | 11,984        | 291   | 1,120        | 19            |
| 0.18.0  | 2026-09-29 | 11,370        | 270   | 1,067        | 18            |
| 0.17.0  | 2026-09-29 | 11,288        | 268   | 1,034        | 17            |
| 0.16.0  | 2026-09-29 | 10,159        | 233   | 1,022        | 16            |
| 0.15.0  | 2026-09-29 | 9,817         | 223   | 971          | 15            |
| 0.14.0  | 2026-09-29 | 9,741         | 218   | 969          | 14            |
| 0.13.0  | 2026-09-29 | 9,507         | 205   | 954          | 13            |
| 0.12.0  | 2026-09-27 | 9,474         | 201   | 954          | 12            |
| 0.11.0  | 2026-09-27 | 9,339         | 195   | 953          | 11            |
| 0.10.0  | 2026-09-27 | 9,326         | 194   | 940          | 10            |
| 0.9.0   | 2026-09-27 | 9,111         | 179   | 906          | 9             |
| 0.8.0   | 2026-09-27 | 9,072         | 173   | 904          | 8             |
| 0.7.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,970         | 165   | 901          | 7             |
| 0.6.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,931         | 163   | 901          | 6             |
| 0.5.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,836         | 157   | 897          | 5             |
| 0.4.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,598         | 144   | 888          | 4             |
| 0.3.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,597         | 141   | 886          | 3             |
| 0.2.0   | 2026-09-27 | 8,336         | 132   | 865          | 2             |
| 0.1.0   | 2026-09-25 | 4,155         | 66    | 703          | 1             |